

Katrina Engelsted

Boulder, Colorado · remote-eligible

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NOLS Hiring Team

National Outdoor Leadership School

RE: MARKETING MANAGER

Dear NOLS Hiring Team,

I'm writing to apply for the Marketing Manager role. Most marketing candidates for a wilderness school have to pick a lane — the campaign-and-analytics side, or the genuine-outdoor-credibility side. **I don't have to pick.** I've spent fifteen years running integrated marketing campaigns, and just as long actually teaching and working in the backcountry.

The wilderness-education half isn't recent. I spent my junior year of high school at the High Mountain Institute, worked trails and outdoor camps throughout college, taught whitewater canoeing, backpacking, and trail maintenance as an instructor in Colgate's Outdoor Education Program, and coach mountain biking today as a PMBIA-certified coach. "Elevating the Leader in Everyone" isn't language I'm learning for this application — it's language I recognize from the inside.

The marketing half is fifteen years of building and running integrated campaigns. As Head of Marketing Technology at Teren, I built persona-driven campaigns that quadrupled qualified leads. As Marketing Automation Manager at Zayo Group, I owned the Salesforce marketing stack — Einstein and Marketing Cloud — and helped lift lead conversion 15% through lead scoring and process automation. At Homebot, I built the email product that got millions of homeowners to actually open and act on communications. **The throughline is the same every time: turn data into a campaign decision, then turn that decision into a story someone reads.**

On the analytics side, I work in Google Analytics and have hands-on Looker Studio experience, on top of dashboards and reporting that have been constant across my career — customer segmentation at Lytics, lead-scoring models at Zayo, custom dashboards for National Park Service staff. On content strategy, I'm going deep right now on AEO (Answer Engine Optimization) — the direction SEO is actually heading as search shifts toward AI answer engines. I'm also used to being the connective tissue between marketing and the rest of an organization — partnering cross-functionally across engineering, product, and sales at Teren, and managing vendor and stakeholder relationships directly at a small retail business more recently.

I've spent much of my career gravitating toward mission-driven organizations — conservation-nonprofit roots in college, and current advisory work at a small water-utility startup. Marketing for an organization I actually believe in, instead of talking myself into a product, is exactly the kind of work I'm looking for. I'm based in Boulder, Colorado, one of NOLS's remote-eligible states, and I'd welcome the chance to complete a NOLS course early on — I can't think of a better way to learn the product I'd be marketing.

Thank you for considering my application. I'd love the opportunity to talk about how my marketing background and lifelong relationship with wilderness education could support NOLS's enrollment and brand goals.

Warmly,

Katrina Engelsted

BOULDER, COLORADO

Katrina Engelsted

MARKETING MANAGER CANDIDATE · NOLS

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SUMMARY

Marketing leader with 15 years of campaign experience and a lifetime in wilderness education. I've built and run integrated marketing campaigns — brand positioning, demand generation, marketing automation (Salesforce Einstein, Marketing Cloud), and email/lifecycle marketing — and I've spent just as long in the backcountry: a junior-year semester at the High Mountain Institute, trail and outdoor-camp work throughout college, teaching outdoor education at Colgate, and PMBIA-certified mountain bike coaching today. Mission-driven by pattern, not by pivot: conservation-nonprofit roots since college and current advisory work at a water-utility startup.

SKILLS

Marketing & Campaigns:	Integrated campaign strategy & execution, brand storytelling, marketing automation (Salesforce Einstein, Marketing Cloud), email/lifecycle marketing, persona development
Analytics & Reporting:	Google Analytics, Looker Studio, customer segmentation, lead scoring, dashboards & reporting, SQL, data-driven campaign optimization
Content & Search:	SEO fundamentals, currently deepening expertise in AEO (Answer Engine Optimization) for AI-driven search
Operations & Collaboration:	Cross-functional partnership (eng/product/sales), vendor & stakeholder management, team hiring & management, project management
Wilderness & Outdoor Ed:	Trail maintenance, whitewater canoeing & backpacking instruction, mountain bike coaching, outdoor-camp leadership

SELECTED OUTCOMES

4x qualified leads:	Persona-driven integrated campaigns, Teren
+15% lead conversion:	Lead scoring & marketing automation, Zayo Group
Millions of opens:	Email marketing product driving homeowner engagement, Homebot

WILDERNESS & OUTDOOR EDUCATION

PMBIA-Certified Mountain Bike Coach — <i>Independent</i>	2023 – Present
- Recruit, train, and coach riders through recurring group clinics every season - Certified at Whistler, BC; also hold Wilderness First Aid and CPR certification	
Outdoor Education Instructor — <i>Colgate University</i>	College era
- Taught whitewater canoeing, backpacking, and trail maintenance - Worked trails and outdoor camps throughout college	
Semester Student — <i>High Mountain Institute (HMI)</i>	Junior year, high school
Semester program in wilderness leadership, backcountry travel, and environmental studies	

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founding Technical Advisor — <i>Upstream AI</i>	2026 – Present
Part-time founding advisor for an early-stage startup building software for small water utilities	
Business Analyst — <i>Sunlight Ski & Bike, Glenwood Springs, CO</i>	2025 – May 2025
- Organized community events — group rides and women's bike mechanical classes — that built brand loyalty and drove foot traffic - Managed inventory, vendor relationships, and reporting to support marketing and business decisions	
Sr. Technical Consultant — <i>Lytics</i>	2022 – 2023
- Built customer-data segments and delivery pipelines for enterprise clients - Led a Whirlpool engagement translating tens of millions of relational records into a usable identity model	
Marketing Automation Manager — <i>Zayo Group</i>	2022
- Owned the Salesforce marketing stack, including Einstein and Marketing Cloud - Built lead scoring and process automation that helped lift lead conversion 15%	
Head of Marketing Technology — <i>Teren (formerly Solspec)</i>	2018 – 2021
- Built persona-driven marketing campaigns that quadrupled qualified leads - Partnered cross-functionally across engineering, product, and sales at a seed-stage startup	
Solutions Engineering Manager — <i>Homebot</i>	2015 – 2018
- Built the email marketing product that drove millions of homeowners to open and act on communications - Hired, managed, and trained the Solutions Engineering team	
Frontend Developer, Digital Maps Team — <i>National Park Service</i>	2012 – 2015
Built custom dashboards and web-mapping tools; cartography work became NPS Park Tiles	

EDUCATION

BA, Geography (GIS), Honors — <i>Colgate University</i>	2011
Honors thesis: 180-page spatial-statistics study of 1,650 WWOOF host farms.	
MBA — <i>Quantic School of Business and Technology</i>	2021
Data Science / ML Certificate — <i>Springboard</i>	2024